

INRL20160: The Politics of the EU

Dr. James P. Cross

2025-2026



Introduction

This module draws on a range of political science research on European integration and European Union politics to analyse the development of the EU and how it operates today. The course addresses one of the most important questions in the study of European politics and international organisations: Why did a diverse group of states construct what is currently the world's most extensive example of international integration? The course provides an extensive overview of the contemporary EU, including its institutions and policy-making processes using approaches from modern political science. We will assess how the EU is coping with economic and political challenges to its prosperity and legitimacy. By the end of the module, students will have a thorough grounding in EU politics and the manner in which EU institutions function and cooperate to make policy.

Contact details and office hours

If you have any questions about the course, please consult the syllabus before contacting module instructors.

Points of contact with module instructors

- **Email:** Please put the course code (INRL20160) in subject line of all correspondences.

Lecturer - James Cross: james.cross@ucd.ie

Teaching assistant - Mafalda Zúquete: mafalda.patacaozuquete@ucdconnect.ie

- **Office hours:** If your question remains unanswered via email, office hours on weeks when lectures take place are available by appointment.

Learning Outcomes

Knowledge and Understanding

Following this course students will develop a range of important transferable skills.

Substantive knowledge

By the end of the course, students should be able to:

- Understand and apply the major theories of European integration.
- Understand the contemporary politics of European integration.
- Display knowledge of the objectives and functioning of key EU institutions and policies.
- Critically assess the successes and failures of EU policies.

Skills (Intellectual and Transferable)

The lectures will encourage you to:

- Listen carefully and critically to orally-presented argument
- Develop selective and efficient note-taking methods
- Make links between material presented at different times, on different issues

The written work in the course (policy brief assignment and examination) will require you to:

- Select relevant material from lectures, literature, news sources, and the web
- Understand, analyse and assess that material
- Produce a sustained, structured and informed answer
- Write in a concise and cogent style
- Employ AI tools to improve rather than replace writing skills and outputs

Assessment

Grade component breakdown

1. Policy brief assignment and associated tasks
 - First draft submitted on time - 10% (Pass/Fail)
 - Workshop participation - 10% (Pass/Fail)
 - Final submission - 30% (Graded)
2. Final exam - 50% (Graded)
 - 2x questions answered @ 25% each

Policy brief assignment

This assignment aims to teach you how to provide policy professionals with accessible summaries of research papers published on topics relevant to EU politics. Policy Briefs offer short (**maximum 1000 words in main text**) high-level takes on research and its findings from a policy perspective.

Purpose: To provide a non-expert and time-poor reader with an understanding of the policy context and findings of a piece of research or literature, along with the key policy messages they should take away from it, so that they can hopefully make better use of the research when designing policy.

Assessment focus: The policy brief assignments are intended to assess your substantive knowledge of European integration and apply the insights you have gained from the course to current issues facing the EU and European integration. The relatively short length of the policy brief means that students must prioritise what they include in their text. They need to think carefully about what elements of their argument need to be developed and what elements can be given less attention.

Guidelines for writing a policy brief

There are **three steps** involved in preparing your assignment:

1. Preparing a first draft ahead of the policy brief workshop
2. Taking part in the workshop and revising your draft based on the feedback received
3. Preparing your final submission and submitting it

Assignment timeline:

1. October 10th - First draft submitted via Brightspace
2. Week 6-7 - Policy brief workshops
3. November 7th - Assignment due

Step 1: Preparing your first draft

The first draft serves as the foundation for your final policy brief and is an essential component of the learning process. This initial version should present your core arguments, policy recommendations, and supporting evidence in a structured format, though it need not be perfectly polished. The primary goal is to develop a coherent policy brief that addresses a specific EU-related issue with clear recommendations.

Your first draft will be submitted via Brightspace by October 10th and constitutes 10% of your overall grade on a Pass/Fail basis. A passing grade requires that you submit a complete draft that demonstrates genuine engagement with the assignment requirements and provides sufficient content for meaningful peer review during the workshop phase.

This draft will form the basis for the peer review sessions in the workshop, so ensure it contains substantive content that your peers can provide constructive feedback on. Focus on developing your main arguments and policy recommendations rather than perfecting every detail – the workshop process is designed to help you refine and strengthen your work.

Keep the following in mind when preparing the first draft of your policy brief assignment:

1. **Purpose of the Policy Brief:** Your policy brief should convince its readers of the urgency of a specific issue related to EU politics and advocate for a particular course of action or policy recommendation.
2. **Structure of the policy brief:**
 - **Executive Summary:** Begin with a concise summary of your main findings and recommendations.
 - **Context and Importance:** Detail the current situation, the significance of the issue, and why it matters in the context of EU politics.
 - **Critique of Policy Options:** Analyse existing policy options or interventions, highlighting strengths, weaknesses, and gaps.

- **Policy Recommendations:** Clearly articulate your proposed solutions or actions, backed by empirical evidence, academic research, and clear reasoning.
 - **Bibliography**
 - A full bibliography of works cited is required
 - It does not count towards the word count.
 - **Appendices:**
 - **Appendix 1 (MANDATORY):** Must provide a complete account of all AI tools used to draft the assignment, including specific prompts and explanations of how you used them. See detailed requirements below under “Documenting AI use”.
 - **Appendix 2 (optional):** Can be used to include supplementary information, data, or sources that support your arguments but don’t fit in the main body. Use sparingly and only include relevant materials.
 - **Important:** Appendices do not count towards the 1000-word limit.
3. **Referencing Academic Debates:** Ground your brief in current academic debates and literature. Highlight where your topic fits within these discussions and how it contributes or challenges existing viewpoints.
 4. **Clarity and Conciseness:** Your brief should be well-written, clear, and concise. Avoid jargon; make it accessible for individuals who may not be experts in EU politics (like your future boss!).
 5. **Evidence-Based:** Support your arguments and recommendations with solid evidence. This could come from academic research, reports, surveys, or expert interviews, and be related to EU politics or the policy issue under discussion.
 6. **Audience:** Keep in mind the diverse audience that might read your policy brief. This could range from policymakers, researchers, to the general public interested in EU politics.
 7. **Layout and Presentation:** Use clear headings, bullet points, and possibly charts or illustrations to make your brief visually appealing and easy to navigate. Make sure to cite all data sources appropriately.
 8. **Length:** Aim for no more than 1000 words excluding the bibliography and appendices, ensuring that every word counts and contributes to your overall argument and purpose.

Step 2: Policy brief workshop

In Week 6-7 you will attend a policy-brief workshop in order to improve your first draft. The workshop will provide structured peer feedback and instructor guidance to help you refine your policy brief before final submission.

Workshop Structure:

- **Peer Review Sessions:** You will work in small groups to provide constructive feedback on each other's first drafts, focusing on clarity of arguments, policy recommendations, and use of evidence.
- **Instructor-Led Discussion:** Targeted feedback sessions addressing common issues identified in first drafts, including structure, academic integration, and policy relevance.
- **Revision Planning:** Time allocated to develop a clear revision strategy based on feedback received.

Workshop Participation Requirements:

- **Preparation:** Come prepared with specific questions about your draft and areas where you seek feedback.
- **Active Engagement:** Provide thoughtful, constructive feedback to peers and participate actively in discussions.
- **Documentation:** Keep notes on feedback received to inform your revision process.

Assessment:

Workshop participation constitutes 10% of your overall grade (Pass/Fail). To receive a pass, you must attend the workshop, engage constructively with peer feedback, and demonstrate that you are using the workshop to improve your policy brief.

The workshop feedback should directly inform your final submission revision process, helping you strengthen arguments, improve clarity, and enhance the policy relevance of your brief.

Step 3: Final submission

The following guidelines **must** be followed when preparing your final assignment submission:

- **Word Count:** The main text must be strictly under 1000 words (not 1000+ words).
- **What doesn't count:** Bibliography and appendices are excluded from the 1000-word limit.
- **Mandatory Requirements:**
 - Appendix 1 documenting all AI tool usage (see guidelines below)
 - Complete bibliography of all sources cited
 - Declaration of authorship form (link below)
- **Submission Deadline:** No later than 5 p.m. on 7th November 2025.

- **Extension requests:** Submit here https://docs.google.com/forms/d/e/1FAIpQLScVG2nq0TR1Tc_BMhVg8-10LZS4XoY81N55PrHznByZMzQsmA/viewform?usp=header ahead of deadline.

- **Format:** Submit as PDF via Brightspace only - no hard copy required.
- **Declaration Form:** Must also submit via Brightspace: <https://www.ucd.ie/spire/filestore/School%20Declaration%20of%20Authorship%202022.pdf>

A selection of the best policy brief shall be published (with the author's consent) on the Dublin European Institute's blog found at <https://www.europedebate.ie>. This widely read and highly visible platform provides the opportunity for students to contribute to the public debate about European integration in a concrete manner to a national and international audience. It also allows students to publicly demonstrate their mastery of their chosen topic in a professional context, and as such represents a great opportunity to build a profile for future employers be they in academia, the public sector or the private sector.

Use of AI Tools

This module encourages the thoughtful use of AI tools as learning partners to deepen your understanding of EU politics. **See the comprehensive AI guidance section at the end of this document for detailed instructions on how to use AI effectively for learning, quality assurance frameworks, and documentation requirements.** All AI use must comply with UCD's academic integrity policies: <https://libguides.ucd.ie/academicintegrity>.

Enhanced Documentation Requirements for Appendix 1:

- All AI interactions must be documented in tabular format in a mandatory Appendix 1
- AI should enhance your critical thinking, not replace it
- All AI-generated insights must be verified against independent sources
- Focus on using AI for exploration, analysis, and refinement rather than answer generation

Your AI appendix must demonstrate learning, not just usage. For each AI interaction, you must document:

Mandatory Reflection Questions:

- How did your AI interactions change your understanding of the topic?
- What questions did AI help you formulate that you wouldn't have asked otherwise?
- Which AI suggestions did you reject, and why?
- How did you verify AI-generated insights against academic sources?

AI Tool	Learning Purpose	Key Prompts	What You Learned
ChatGPT	Exploring democratic deficit arguments	“What are the strongest critiques of EU democratic legitimacy?”	Identified 3 main theoretical frameworks I hadn’t considered; led me to Follesdal & Hix (2006)
Claude	Testing my policy argument	“I argue X about EU migration policy. What are the counter-arguments?”	Realised my argument ignored economic impacts; strengthened by adding economic evidence

Table 1: Enhanced AI Learning Log Template

Policy brief grading rubric

The following guidelines should be adhered to when writing your policy brief. The rubric is also useful for structuring your thoughts when preparing your policy brief.

- **Statement of Purpose/ Focus and Organisation - 30%**

- The response is fully sustained and consistently and purposefully focused:
 - * Claims are clearly stated, focused, and strongly maintained
 - * Claims are introduced and communicated appropriately for the purpose, audience, and task
 - * Alternate or opposing claims are clearly addressed
- The response has a clear and effective organisational structure creating unity and completeness:
 - * A variety of transitional strategies is consistently used to effectively clarify the relationships between and among ideas
 - * The progression of ideas from beginning to end is logical
 - * The introduction and conclusion are effective for audience and purpose
 - * Appropriate sentence structure variety produce strong connection between ideas

- **Evidence/Elaboration - 30%**

- The response provides thorough and convincing support/evidence for the writer’s claim that includes the effective use of sources, facts, and details. The response achieves substantial depth that is specific and relevant:
 - * Claims are supported with relevant evidence from credible sources and clear reasoning
 - * Use of evidence from sources is smoothly integrated, cited, comprehensive, and concrete
 - * A variety of effective argumentative techniques is used
- The response demonstrates strategic use of language to produce clear communication:

- * Precise language clearly and effectively expresses ideas
- * The use of academic and domain-specific vocabulary is clearly appropriate for the audience and purpose
- **Editing Conventions - 20%**
 - The response displays adequate command of all grade level and preceding level conventions of writing:
 - * Some errors in usage and sentence formation may be present, but no systematic pattern of errors is displayed
 - * The use of punctuation, capitalisation, and spelling is adequate
- **AI use and documentation - 20%**
 - The response demonstrates responsible and learning-centred AI usage with comprehensive documentation evidencing the following:
 - * Complete documentation of all AI interactions in mandatory appendix, including specific tools, prompts, and learning purposes
 - * Clear evidence that AI was used to enhance critical thinking and understanding of EU politics rather than replace intellectual engagement
 - * All AI-generated insights are verified against independent academic sources and properly attributed
 - * Thoughtful reflection on how AI interactions changed understanding and contributed to learning outcomes

End of year exam - 50%

There will be an exam at the end of the semester. This examination will constitute 50% of your final mark. This will either be an in-person or take-home exam depending on the covid-19 restrictions in place at the time. Example exams demonstrating the structure and requirements of the end of year exam will be distributed in due course.

There will be **6 questions** on the exam and you have to **answer 2** of them.

Course reading

Required readings:

The following texts shall be used extensively throughout the course, so it is recommended that you get access to them.

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. European Union Politics. Oxford University Press. 8th ed.
- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. The Political System of the European Union. Palgrave Macmillan. 4th Ed.

Recommended Readings

The following books provide a general overview of the topics that will be covered in this module.

- Wallace, H., Pollack, M.A. and Young, A.R. eds. 2015. Policy-making in the European Union. Oxford University Press, USA.
- Bomberg, E., Peterson, J. and Corbett, R. 2012. The European Union: how does it work?. Oxford University Press.
- Bache, I., Bulmer, S., George, S. and Parker, O. 2014. Politics in the European Union. Oxford University Press, USA.
- Hix, S. 2013. What's Wrong with the Europe Union and How to Fix it. John Wiley & Sons.
- Majone, G. 2009. Dilemmas of European integration: the ambiguities and pitfalls of integration by stealth. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Peterson, J. and Shackleton, M. 2012. The institutions of the European Union. Oxford University Press.
- Thomson, R. 2011. Resolving controversy in the European Union: legislative decision-making before and after enlargement. Cambridge University Press.
- Wiener, A. and Diez, T. 2009. European integration theory. Oxford: Oxford University Press.

In addition to these readings, students should keep up to date on current European affairs by reading daily newspapers, or one of the many websites devoted to EU politics. This reading is essential as it will allow you to keep up to date with current affairs in the EU and identify potential policy brief topics. These websites include the following:

- <https://euobserver.com>
- <https://europa.eu>
- <http://www.eupolitics.com>
- <https://www.ft.com>
- <https://blogs.lse.ac.uk/europpblog/>
- <https://blogs.lse.ac.uk/brexit/>

Brightspace

Please make sure you have access to the module in Brightspace as soon as possible. It is the student's responsibility to make sure that they are signed up to the module correctly and they know how to submit coursework through the appropriate Brightspace assignment tab. If you have any issues with Brightspace contact the Brightspace support people to resolve the issue.

Furthermore, module materials such as this syllabus and announcements made outside lectures shall be on Brightspace. As such, Brightspace is an important communication tool for the module.

Detailed course programme

Week 1

Introduction and the history of European integration

Study questions

- What are the major challenges, threats, and opportunities facing the EU today? How do you think these issues will affect the EU and shape its future?
- What are the main milestones that the integration process in Europe went through?
- How has the European integration project developed over time and how has the policy remit of the EU evolved?
- How have global events and geopolitical shifts influenced the EU's objectives and policies?
- What have been the key drivers of enlargement and deeper integration within the EU?
- Can you identify any points in history where the EU could have taken a different developmental path? What might have been the outcomes?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. European Union Politics. Oxford University Press. Chapter 1-3.

Further reading

- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. The Political System of the European Union. Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 1.
- Urwin, D.W. 2014. The community of Europe: A history of European integration since 1945. Routledge.
- Dinan, D. 2010. Ever Closer Union: An Introduction to European Integration. London: Palgrave Macmillan. Chapters 1-6.

- Marks, G. 2011. Europe and Its Empires: From Rome to the European Union. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 50(1), pp.1-20.
- Nugent, N. 2010. *The Government and Politics of the European Union*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan, Part 1: Chapters 1-7.
- Bache, I. and George, S. 2011. *Politics in the European Union*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, Chapters 5-11.
- Diebold, W. 1959. *The Schuman Plan*. New York: Praeger.
- Dougan, M. 2008. The Treaty of Lisbon 2007: Winning Minds not Hearts. *Common Market Law Review* 45, pp.617–703.
- Gray, M. and Stubb, A. 2001. Keynote Article: The Treaty of Nice–Negotiating a Poisoned Chalice?. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 39(s1), pp.5-23.
- Magnette, P. and Nicolaidis, K. 2004. The European Convention: bargaining in the shadow of rhetoric. *West European Politics*, 27(3), pp.381-404.
- Majone, G. 2006. The Common Sense of European Integration. *Journal of European Public Policy* 13(5), pp.607-626.
- Piris, J-C. 2010. *The Lisbon Treaty: a legal and political analysis*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.

Week 2

Theories of European integration

Study questions

- Describe the main logic behind neofunctionalism as a theory of European integration. Can this theory successfully explain how we got to where we are now in terms of EU integration?
- Describe the main logic behind intergovernmentalism. Does this theory do a better job of explaining the European integration project than neofunctionalism?
- What are the strengths and weaknesses of both theories of integration?
- What are the three different types of institutionalism? How do they differ from one another?
- How do institutionalist theories differ from the ‘grand’ theories of integration that went before?
- How successful are institutionalist theories at explaining EU politics?
- Are there any recent developments or crises in the EU that challenge the premises of these theories?
- How have institutionalist theories evolved to account for the complexities and nuances of modern EU politics?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Pérez-Solórzano Borragán, N. (eds.) 2025. *European Union Politics*, Oxford: Oxford University Press. Chapters 4-5.
- Moravcsik, A. 1993. Preferences and Power in the European Community. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 31(4), pp.473-524.
- Aspinwall, M. and Schneider, G. 2000. Same Menu, Separate Tables: The Institutional Turn in Political Science and the Study of European Integration. *European Journal of Political Research* 38, pp.1-36.

Further reading

- Hooghe, L., Marks, G., 2019. Grand theories of European integration in the twenty-first century. *Journal of European Public Policy* 26, 1113–1133. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2019.1569711>
- Rauh, C., 2019. Between neo-functionalist optimism and post-functionalist pessimism: Integrating politicisation into integration theory.
- Carstensen, M.B., Schmidt, V.A., 2016. Power through, over and in ideas: conceptualizing ideational power in discursive institutionalism. *Journal of European Public Policy* 23, 318–337. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2015.1115534>
- Hoffmann, S. 1966. Obstinate or obsolete? The fate of the nation-state and the case of Western Europe. *Daedalus*, pp.862-915.
- Haas, E.B. 1976. Turbulent Fields and the Theory of Regional Integration. *International Organization* 30, pp.173-212.
- Monnet, J. 1978. *Memoirs*. New York: Doubleday.
- Bache, I. and George, S. 2011. *Politics in the European Union*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, Chapter 1.
- Haas, E.B. 1958. *The Uniting of Europe*. Stanford: Stanford University Press.
- Haas, E.B. 1961. International Integration: The European and Universal Process. *International Organization* 15(3), pp.366-92.
- Haas, E.B. 1975. *The Obsolescence of Regional Integration Theory*. Berkeley: Institute of International Studies.
- Hooghe, L and Marks G. 2001. *Multi-Level Governance and European Integration*. Oxford: Rowman and Littlefield.
- Jupille, J. and Caporaso, J.A. 1999. Institutionalism and the European Union: Beyond Comparative Politics and International Relations. *Annual Review Political Science* 2, pp.429-44.
- Moravcsik, A. 1998. *The Choice For Europe: Social Purpose And State Power From Messina To Maastricht*. Cornell University Press, Chapter 1, 7.

- Nugent, N. 2010. *The Government and Politics of the European Union*. London: Palgrave Macmillan, Chapter 23.
- Pollack, M.A. 2003. *The Engines of European Integration: Delegation, Agency and Agenda Setting in the EU*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Pollock, M.A. 2005. Theorizing the EU: International Organization, Domestic Polity, or Experiment in New Governance? *Annual Review Political Science*. 8, pp.357–98.
- Rosamond, B. 2000. *Theories of European Integration* London: MacMillan, Chapters 2 and 3.
- Sandholtz, W. And Sweet Stone, A. 1998. *European Integration and Supranational Governance*. Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Weiner, A. and Diez, T. 2009. *European Integration Theory*. Oxford: Oxford University Press (2nd Edition).
- Hooghe, L. and Marks, G. 2009. A Postfunctionalist Theory of European Integration: From Permissive Consensus to Constraining Dissensus. *British Journal of Political Science* 39(1), pp.1-23.
- Pierson P. 1996., The path to European Integration: An Historical Institutional Perspective. *Comparative Political Studies*. 29(2), pp.123-63.
- Tsebelis, G. and Garrett, G. 2001., The Institutional Foundations of Intergovernmentalism and Supranationalism. *International Organization* 55(2), pp.357-90.
- Bickerton, C.J., Hodson, D. and Puetter, U. 2014. The new intergovernmentalism: European integration in the post-Maastricht era. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 53(4), pp.703–22.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2015a. What’s the news in ‘new intergovernmentalism’? A critique of Bickerton, Hodson and Puetter. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 53(4), pp.723–30.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2015. Liberal intergovernmentalism and the euro area crisis. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(2), pp.177-195.
- Puetter, U. 2016. The centrality of consensus and deliberation in contemporary EU politics and the new intergovernmentalism. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.601-615.
- Puetter, U. and Fabbrini, S. 2016. Catalysts of integration—the role of core intergovernmental forums in EU politics. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.633-642.
- Kleine, M., and Pollack, M. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism and Its Critics. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1493–1509.
- Moravcsik, A. 2018. Preferences, Power and Institutions in 21st-century Europe. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1648-1674.

- Meunier, S., and Vachudova, M. A. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism, Illiberalism and the Potential Superpower of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1631–1647.
- Hix, S. 2018. When Optimism Fails: Liberal Intergovernmentalism and Citizen Representation. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1595–1613.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism and the Crises of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1578–1594.
- Schimmelfennig, F. 2018. European integration (theory) in times of crisis. A comparison of the Euro and Schengen crises, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 25(7), pp.969–989
- Schmidt, V. A. 2018. Rethinking EU Governance: From Old to New Approaches to Who Steers Integration. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1544–1561.
- Naurin, D. 2018. Liberal Intergovernmentalism in the Councils of the EU: A Baseline Theory?. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1526–1543.
- McNamara, K. R. 2018. Authority Under Construction: The European Union in Comparative Political Perspective. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.1510–1525.
- Jones, E. 2018. Towards a theory of disintegration, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 25(3), pp.440–451.
- Rauh, C., 2019. Between neo-functionalist optimism and post-functionalist pessimism: Integrating politicisation into integration theory. Working paper.
- Genschel, P. and Jachtenfuchs, M., 2018. From market integration to core state powers: the Eurozone crisis, the refugee crisis and integration theory. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56(1), pp.178–196.

Week 3

Executive politics

Study questions

- How is the European Council structured? What strengths and weaknesses arise from this structure in terms of its ability to influence the direction of the EU?
- How is the European Commission structured? How does it fit into the institutional structure of the EU?
- Does the institutional structure of the Commission help or hinder its ability to make policy?
- What roles do the European Council and Commission play in the political system of the EU? How do their roles differ?
- Explain principle-agent theory. Does this theory successfully describe the sources of Commission power and influence in EU politics?

- How do the European Council and the European Commission collaborate or conflict in setting EU policies?
- How have the roles and powers of these institutions evolved in response to crises or major policy shifts?
- What impact do changes in the leadership of the European Council and Commission have on EU policy direction?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. *European Union Politics*. Oxford University Press. Chapters 9, Chapter 10 (part about European Council)
- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. *The political system of the European Union*. Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 2.
- Pollack, M A. 1997. Delegation, Agency, and Agenda Setting in the European Community. *International Organization* 51(1), pp.99–134.

Further reading

- Anastasopoulos, L.J., Bertelli, A.M., 2020. Understanding Delegation Through Machine Learning: A Method and Application to the European Union. *American Political Science Review* 114, 291–301. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0003055419000522>
- Frieden, J., Walter, S., 2019. Analyzing inter-state negotiations in the Eurozone crisis and beyond. *European Union Politics* 20, 134–151. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116518813450>
- Pircher, B., Farjam, M., 2021. Oppositional voting in the Council of the EU between 2010 and 2019: Evidence for differentiated politicisation. *European Union Politics* 22, 472–494. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165211004754>
- Rauh, C., 2021. One agenda-setter or many? The varying success of policy initiatives by individual Directorates-General of the European Commission 1994–2016. *European Union Politics* 22, 3–24. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520961467>
- Vaznonytė, A., 2020. The rotating Presidency of the Council of the EU–Still an agenda-setter?. *European Union Politics*, 21(3) pp.497–518.
- Hobolt, S.B. and Wratil, C., 2020. Contestation and responsiveness in EU Council deliberations. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 27(3), pp.362–381.
- Rauh, C. 2019. EU politicization and policy initiatives of the European Commission: the case of consumer policy, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 26(3), pp.344–365
- Delreux, T. and Adriaensen, J. eds., 2017. *The Principal Agent Model and the European Union*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Delreux, T. and Adriaensen, J. 2017. Twenty years of principal-agent research in EU politics: how to cope with complexity?. *European Political Science*, pp.1–18.

- Conceição-Heldt, E. 2010. Who controls whom? Dynamics of power delegation and agency losses in EU trade politics. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 48(4), pp.1107-1126.
- Nugent, N. and Rhinard, M. 2016. Is the European Commission Really in Decline?. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*. 54(5), pp.1199-1215.
- Brown, S.A. 2016. The Commission and the Crisis: Chief Loser or Unexpected Winner?. In *The European Commission and Europe's Democratic Process*, pp.69-78. Palgrave Macmillan UK.
- Bauer, M.W. and Becker S. 2014. The unexpected winner of the crisis: the European Commission's strengthened role in economic governance. *Journal of European Integration*. 36(3), pp.213-29.
- da Conceição-Heldt, E. 2016. Why the European Commission is not the "unexpected winner" of the Euro crisis: A comment on Bauer and Becker. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(1), pp.95-100.
- Bauer, M.W. and Becker, S. 2016. Absolute Gains Are Still Gains: Why the European Commission Is a Winner of the Crisis, and Unexpectedly So. A Rejoinder to Eugénia da Conceição-Heldt. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(1), pp.101-106.
- Fabbrini, S. and Puetter, U. 2016. Integration without supranationalisation: studying the lead roles of the European Council and the Council in post-Lisbon EU politics. *Journal of European Integration*, 38(5), pp.481-495.
- Bailer, S. 2014. An Agent Dependent on the EU Member States? The Determinants of the European Commission's Legislative Success in the European Union, *Journal of European Integration*, 36(1), pp.37-53.
- Egeberg, M. 2006. Executive Politics as Usual: Role Behaviour and Conflict Dimensions in the College of European Commissioners. *Journal of European Public Policy* 13(1), pp.1-15.
- Franchino, F. 2009. Experience and the Distribution of Portfolio Payoffs in the European Commission. *European Journal of Political Research* 48(1), pp.1-30.
- Franchino, F. 1999. Delegating Powers in the European Community. *British Journal of Political Science* 34(2), pp.269-93.
- Dinan, D. 2010. *Ever Closer Union: An Introduction to European Integration*. London: Palgrave Macmillan, Chapters 7-8.
- Bunse, S. 2009. *Small States and EU Governance: Leadership through the Council Presidency*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Cini, M. 1996. *The European Commission: Leadership, Organisation and Culture in the EU Administration*. Manchester: Manchester University Press.
- Franchino, F. 2009. Experience and the distribution of portfolio payoffs in the European Commission. *European Journal of Political Research* 48(1), pp.1-30.

- Häge, F.M. 2008. Who Decides in the Council of the European Union? *Journal of Common Market Studies* 46(3), pp.533-58.
- Häge, F.M. 2016. Political attention in the Council of the European Union: A new dataset of working party meetings, 1995–2014. *European Union Politics* 17(4), pp.683–703
- Hayes-Renshaw, F. and Wallace H. 2006. *The Council of Ministers*. Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Hooghe, L. 1999. Images of Europe: Orientations to European Integration Among Senior Officials of the Commission. *British Journal of Political Science* 29:345–367.
- Hooghe, L. 2002. *The European Commission and the Integration of Europe*. New York: Cambridge University Press.
- Hooghe, L. 2005. Several Roads Lead to International Norms, But Few via International Socialization: A Case Study of the European Commission. *International Organization* 59: 861-898.
- Rasmussen, A. 2007. Challenging the Commission's Right of Initiative? Conditions for Institutional Change and Stability. *West European Politics* 30(2), pp.244-64.
- Tallberg, J. 2008. Bargaining Power in the European Council. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 46(3), pp.685-708.
- Thomson, R. 2008. National Actors in International Organizations: The Case of the European Commission. *Comparative Political Studies* 41: 169-92.
- Tsebelis, G. and Garrett G. 2000. Legislative Politics in the EU. *European Union Politics* 1, pp.9–36.
- Wallace, H., Pollock, M, and Young, A.R. 2010. *Policy-Making in the European Union*. Oxford: Oxford University Press, Chapter 4.
- Wonka, A. 2007. Technocratic and Independent? The Appointment of European Commissioners and its Policy Implications. *Journal of European Public Policy* 14(2), pp.169-89.
- Slapin, J.B. 2006. Who Is Powerful?: Examining Preferences and Testing Sources of Bargaining Strength at European Intergovernmental Conferences. *European Union Politics* 7 (1), pp.51–76.
- Hug, S, and König, T. 2002. In View of Ratification: Governmental Preferences and Domestic Constraints at the Amsterdam Intergovernmental Conference. *International Organization* 56 (02), pp.447–76.

Week 4 and Week 5

Legislative politics

Study questions

- Describe the different legislative procedures used in the EU. How do they differ from one another?
- Describe the internal structure of the Council of Ministers. How are legislative powers and influence distributed between 1) the member states in terms of voting power? and 2) between the different levels of negotiation within the Council?
- Describe the internal structure of the European Parliament. What are the main dimensions of political conflict in the EP? How stable are coalitions between the EP party groups?
- What are some real-world examples where the legislative procedure significantly influenced the outcome of a policy?
- How have changes in the balance of power among EU institutions impacted legislative processes?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. *European Union Politics*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 10 (part about Council of Ministers), Chapter 11, 15
- Hix, S. and Hoyland B. 2022. *The political system of the European Union*. Palgrave, Chapter 3.
- Hix, S., Noury, A. and Roland G. 2009. Voting Patterns and Alliance Formation in the European Parliament. *Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society B*, 364: 821-831.
- Cross, J.P. and Hermansson, H. 2017. Legislative amendments and informal politics in the European Union: A text reuse approach. *European Union Politics*, 18(4), pp.581-602.

Further reading

- Crum, B., 2023. Why the European Parliament lost the Spitzenkandidaten-process. *Journal of European Public Policy* 30, 193–213. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2022.2032285>
- Gattermann, K., Marquart, F., 2020. Do Spitzenkandidaten really make a difference? An experiment on the effectiveness of personalized European Parliament election campaigns. *European Union Politics* 21, 612–633. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520938148>
- Haag, M., 2022. Bargaining power in informal trilogues: Intra-institutional preference cohesion and inter-institutional bargaining success. *European Union Politics* 23, 330–350. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165211064485>
- Häge, F.M., Ringe, N., 2020. Top-down or bottom-up? The selection of shadow rapporteurs in the European Parliament. *European Union Politics* 21, 706–727. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520934865>

- Hermansen, S.S.L., Pegan, A., 2023. Blurred lines between electoral and parliamentary representation: The use of constituency staff among Members of the European Parliament. *European Union Politics* 24, 239–263. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165221149900>
- Hurka, S., Haag, M., 2020. Policy complexity and legislative duration in the European Union. *European Union Politics* 21, 87–108. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116519859431>
- Lovato, M., Maurer, H., 2022. Process and position power: a social relational research agenda about state power in negotiations. *Journal of European Public Policy* 29, 1994–2006. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2022.2135755>
- Ringe, N., 2005. Policy Preference Formation in Legislative Politics: Structures, Actors, and Focal Points. *American Journal of Political Science* 49, 731–745. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1540-5907.2005.00151.x>
- Rovny, J., Whitefield, S., 2019. Issue dimensionality and party competition in turbulent times. *Party Politics* 25, 4–11. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1354068818816970>
- Yordanova, N. and Zhelyazkova, A., 2020. Legislative Control over Executive Law-making: Delegation of Quasi-legislative Powers to the European Commission. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 58(2), pp.345-364.
- Wratil, C. 2018. Modes of government responsiveness in the European Union: Evidence from Council negotiation positions. *European Union Politics*, 19(1), pp.52–74.
- Thomson, R. and Hosli, M. 2006. Who Has Power in the EU? *Journal of Common Market Studies* 44(2), pp.391-417.
- Huhe, N., Naurin, D., and Thomson, R. 2018. The evolution of political networks: Evidence from the Council of the European Union. *European Union Politics*, 19(1), pp.25–51.
- Rasmussen, A. and Reh, C. 2013. The consequences of concluding codecision early: trilogues and intra-institutional bargaining success. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 20(7), pp.1006-1024.
- Rasmussen, A. 2011. Early conclusion in bicameral bargaining: Evidence from the co-decision legislative procedure of the European Union. *European Union Politics*, 12(1), pp.41-64.
- Rasmussen, A. 2008. The EU Conciliation Committee One or Several Principals?. *European Union Politics*, 9(1), pp.87-113.
- Rasmussen, A. 2012. Twenty Years of Co-decision Since Maastricht: Inter-and Intrainstitutional Implications. *Journal of European Integration*, 34(7), pp.735-751.
- Reh, C., Héritier, A., Bressanelli, E. and Koop, C. 2013. The informal politics of legislation explaining secluded decision making in the European Union. *Comparative Political Studies*, 46(9), pp.1112-1142.

- Mühlböck, M., & Rittberger, B. 2015. The Council, the European Parliament, and the paradox of inter-institutional cooperation. *European Integration online Papers (EIoP)*, 19.
- Brandsma, G. J. 2015. Co-decision after Lisbon: The politics of informal trilogues in European Union lawmaking. *European Union Politics*, 16(2), pp.300-319
- Dinan, D. 2010. *Ever Closer Union: An Introduction to European Integration* London: Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 9.
- Corbett, R., Jacobs, F. and Shackleton, M. 2005. *The European Parliament*. London: John Harper
- Costello, R. and Thomson, R. 2010. The Policy Impact of Leadership in Committees: Rapporteurs' Influence on the European Parliament's Opinions. *European Union Politics* 11(1), pp.1-26.
- Cross, J.P. 2013. Everyone's a winner (almost): Bargaining success in the Council of Ministers of the European Union. *European Union Politics*, 14(1), pp.70-94.
- Cross, J.P. 2012. Interventions and negotiation in the Council of Ministers of the European Union. *European Union Politics*, 13(1), pp.47-69.
- Hayes-Renshaw, F., Van Aken, W. and Wallace, H. 2006. When and Why the EU Council of Ministers Votes Explicitly. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 44: 161-94.
- Hix, S., Noury, A. and Roland, G. 2007. *Democratic Politics in the European Parliament*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, Chapters 1, 5, 6, 9.
- Judge, D. and Earnshaw, D. 2008. *The European Parliament*. London: Palgrave. (2nd ed.).
- König, T, Lindburg, B, Lechner, S. and Pohlmeier, W. 2007. Bicameral Conflict Resolution in the European Union: An Empirical Analysis of Conciliation Committee Bargains. *British Journal of Political Science* 37, pp.281-312.
- Kreppel, A. 2002. *The European Parliament and Supranational Party System: A Study in Institutional Development*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Mattila, M. 2009. Roll Call Analysis of Voting in the EU Council of Ministers after the 2004 Enlargement. *European Journal of Political Research* 48, pp.840-57.
- McElroy, G. and Benoit, K. 2007. Party Groups and Policy Positions in the European Parliament. *Party Politics* 13, pp.5-28.
- McElroy, G. and Benoit, K. 2010. Party Policy and Group Affiliation in the European Parliament. *British Journal of Political Science* 40(2), pp.377-98.
- Naurin, D. and Lindahl, R. 2010. Out in the Cold? Flexible Integration and the Political Status of Euro Opt-Outs. *European Union Politics* 11(4), pp.485-509.

- Thomson, R. 2008. The Relative Power of Member States in the Council: Large and Small, Old and New. In Naurin, D. and Wallace, H. (eds.) *Unveiling the Council of the European Union: Games Governments Play in Brussels*. London: Palgrave Macmillan, pp.238-60.
- Thomson, R. 2009. Actor Alignments in the European Union Before and After Enlargement. *European Journal of Political Research* 48, pp.756-81.
- Ringe, N. 2005. Policy Preference Formation in Legislative Politics: Structures, Actors, and Focal Points. *American Journal of Political Science* 49(4), pp.731–746.

Week 6

Judicial politics and compliance

Study questions

- Describe the structure of the European Court of Justice and the different procedures the ECJ has at its disposal to enforce EU law?
- What role does the European Court of Justice play in the political system of the EU? What powers does it yield and what are the limits of these powers?
- What do we mean by the term ‘judicial activism’? Does the ECJ engage in judicial activism often? How have member states reacted to examples of judicial activism by the ECJ?
- What difficulties might arise when Member States transpose EU laws into national laws?
- We observe significant variation in the levels of compliance with EU law both between Member States and over time. What can explain this variation?
- Why might member states fail to comply with EU legislation? What incentives are involved in compliance and non-compliance?
- How do ECJ decisions interact with national legal systems, and what challenges arise from this interaction?
- How has the role of the ECJ evolved in the context of expanding EU competencies?
- Can you identify any landmark ECJ cases that had a significant impact on EU integration or member state relations?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. *European Union Politics*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 12.
- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. *The political system of the European Union*. Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 4.
- Angelova, M., Dannwolf, T. and König, T. 2012. How Robust are Compliance Findings. *Journal of European Public Policy* 19(8), pp.1269-91.

Further reading

- Caldeira, G.A., Gibson, J.L., 1995. The Legitimacy of the Court of Justice in the European Union: Models of Institutional Support. *American Political Science Review* 89, 356–376. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2082430>
- Cheruvu, S., 2022. When does the European Commission Pursue Noncompliance? *European Union Politics* 23, 375–397. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165221087635>
- Fjelstul, J.C., Carrubba, C.J., 2018. The Politics of International Oversight: Strategic Monitoring and Legal Compliance in the European Union. *American Political Science Review* 112, 429–445. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0003055418000096>
- König, T., Mäder, L., 2014. The Strategic Nature of Compliance: An Empirical Evaluation of Law Implementation in the Central Monitoring System of the European Union. *American Journal of Political Science* 58, 246–263. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ajps.12038>
- Ovádek, M., 2021. Supranationalism, constrained? Locating the Court of Justice on the EU integration dimension. *European Union Politics* 22, 46–69. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520967414>
- Caldeira, G.A., Gibson, J.L., 1995. The Legitimacy of the Court of Justice in the European Union: Models of Institutional Support. *American Political Science Review* 89, 356–376. <https://doi.org/10.2307/2082430>
- Closa, C. 2018. The politics of guarding the Treaties: Commission scrutiny of rule of law compliance, *Journal of European Public Policy*
- Jaremba, U. and Mayoral, J.A. 2019. The Europeanization of national judiciaries: definitions, indicators and mechanisms, *Journal of European Public Policy*, 26(3), pp.386-406
- Peritz, L. 2018. Obstructing integration: Domestic politics and the European Court of Justice. *European Union Politics*, 19(3), pp.427–457.
- Hartlapp, M. 2018. Power Shifts via the Judicial Arena: How Annulments Cases between EU Institutions Shape Competence Allocation. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56: pp.1429–1445.
- Kleine, M. 2014. Informal Governance in the European Union. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 21(2), pp.303-314.
- Zhelyazkova, A. and Yordanova, N. 2015. Signalling compliance: The link between notified EU directive implementation and infringement cases. *European Union Politics* 16(3), pp.408-428
- Carrubba, C.J., Gabel, M. and Hankla, C. 2008. Judicial behavior under political constraints: Evidence from the European Court of Justice. *American Political Science Review*, 102(04), pp.435-452.

- Sweet, A.S. and Brunell, T. 2012. The European Court of Justice, state noncompliance, and the politics of override. *American Political Science Review*, 106(01), pp.204-213.
- Alter, K.J. 2000. The European Union's legal system and domestic policy: spillover or backlash?. *International Organization*, 54(03), pp.489-518.
- Bache, I., George, S. and Bulmer, S. 2011. *Politics in the European Union* Oxford: Oxford University Press, Chapter 23
- Chalmers, D., Davies, G. and Monti, G. 2010. *European Union Law*. Cambridge University Press, Chapter 4.
- Garrett, G. 1995. The Politics of Legal Integration in the European Union. *International Organization* 49(1), pp.171-81.
- Luetgert, B. and Dannwolf, T. 2009. Mixing Method: A Nested Analysis of EU Member State Transposition Patterns. *European Union Politics* 10/3, pp.307-34.
- Thomson, R. 2010. Opposition through the Back Door in the Transposition of EU Directives. *European Union Politics* 12, pp.337-57.
- Thomson, R., Torenvlied, R., and Arregui, J. 2007. The Paradox of Compliance: Infringements and Delays in Transposing European Union Directives. *British Journal of Political Science* 37, pp.685-709.
- König, T., and Mäder, L. 2013. Non-conformable, partial and conformable transposition: A competing risk analysis of the transposition process of directives in the EU15. *European Union Politics*, 14(1), pp.46-69.
- König, T. and Mäder, L. 2014. The Strategic Nature of Compliance: An Empirical Evaluation of Law Implementation in the Central Monitoring System of the European Union. *American Journal of Political Science*, 58, pp.246-263.
- Steunenberg, B. 2006. Turning Swift Policy-making into Deadlock and Delay National Policy Coordination and the Transposition of EU Directives. *European Union Politics*, 7(3), pp.293-319.

Week 7

Elections, referenda, and public opinion

Study questions

- How has public opinion towards the EU changed over time? What explains this variation?
- What different theories have attempted to explain public attitudes towards the EU? Which of these theories is most convincing and why?
- What do we mean when we describe the EP elections as second order in nature? Is this a fair description of EP elections at this point in the history of the EU?

- How do national events or crises impact public opinion about the EU? Can you provide examples?
- How do political parties within member states influence public opinion about the EU?
- Is voter turnout in EP elections indicative of public interest and opinion toward the EU? Why or why not?

Key reading

- Explore EUOPINIONS website: <http://eupinions.eu/de/home/>
- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. *European Union Politics*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 14
- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. *The Political System of the European Union*. Palgrave Macmillan (4th edition), Chapters 5-6.
- Boomgaarden, H.G., Schuck, A.R., Elenbaas, M. and De Vreese, C.H. 2011. Mapping EU attitudes: Conceptual and empirical dimensions of Euroscepticism and EU support. *European Union Politics*, 12(2), pp.241-266.
- Beach, D., Hansen, K., and Larsen, M. 2018. How Campaigns Enhance European Issues Voting During European Parliament Elections. *Political Science Research and Methods*, 6(4), pp.791-808.

Further reading

- Wratil, C., 2019. Territorial Representation and the Opinion–Policy Linkage: Evidence from the European Union. *American Journal of Political Science* 63, 197–211. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ajps.12403>
- Dutceac Segesten, A., Bossetta, M., 2019. Can Euroscepticism Contribute to a European Public Sphere? The Europeanization of Media Discourses on Euroscepticism across Six Countries. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 57, 1051–1070. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jcms.12871>
- Crum, B., 2023. Why the European Parliament lost the Spitzenkandidaten-process. *Journal of European Public Policy* 30, 193–213. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2022.2032285>
- Caughey, D., O’Grady, T., Warshaw, C., 2019. Policy Ideology in European Mass Publics, 1981–2016. *American Political Science Review* 113, 674–693. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0003055419000157>
- Dutceac Segesten, A., Bossetta, M., 2019. Can Euroscepticism Contribute to a European Public Sphere? The Europeanization of Media Discourses on Euroscepticism across Six Countries. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 57, 1051–1070. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jcms.12871>
- Ford, R., Jennings, W., 2020. The Changing Cleavage Politics of Western Europe. *Annu. Rev. Polit. Sci.* 23, 295–314.

- Foster, C., Frieden, J., 2021. Economic determinants of public support for European integration, 1995–2018. *European Union Politics* 22, 266–292. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116521994181>
- Gehring, K., 2021. Overcoming History Through Exit or Integration: Deep-Rooted Sources of Support for the European Union. *American Political Science Review* 115, 199–217. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0003055420000842>
- Kunst, S., Kuhn, T., van de Werfhorst, H.G., 2020. Does education decrease Euroscepticism? A regression discontinuity design using compulsory schooling reforms in four European countries. *European Union Politics* 21, 24–42. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116519877972>
- Marquart, F., Goldberg, A.C., de Vreese, C.H., 2020. ‘This time I’m (not) voting’: A comprehensive overview of campaign factors influencing turnout at European Parliament elections. *European Union Politics* 21, 680–705. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520943670>
- Moloney, D., Whitaker, R., 2023. Working up the six-pack: Bargaining success in the European Council’s task force on strengthening economic governance. *European Union Politics* 24, 559–577. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165231157601>
- Partheymüller, J., Kritzinger, S., Plescia, C., 2022. Misinformedness about the European Union and the Preference to Vote to Leave or Remain. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 60, 1449–1469. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jcms.13316>
- Plescia, C., Daoust, J.-F., Blais, A., 2021. Do European elections enhance satisfaction with European Union democracy? *European Union Politics* 22, 94–113. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520970280>
- Rooduijn, M., Bonikowski, B., Parlevliet, J., 2021. Populist and nativist attitudes: Does ingroup-outgroup thinking spill over across domains? *European Union Politics* 22, 248–265. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116521992876>
- Schafheitle, S., Weibel, A., Meidert, N., Leuffen, D., 2020. The Road to Trust. A Vignette Study on the Determinants of Citizens’ Trust in the European Commission. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 58, 256–275. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jcms.12901>
- Stoeckel, F., Mérola, V., Thompson, J., Lyons, B., Reifler, J., 2023. Public perceptions and misperceptions of political authority in the European Union. *European Union Politics* 14651165231193832. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165231193833>
- Talving, L., Vasilopoulou, S., 2021. Linking two levels of governance: Citizens’ trust in domestic and European institutions over time. *Electoral Studies* 70, 102289. <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2021.102289>
- van der Brug, W., Gattermann, K., de Vreese, C.H., 2022. Electoral responses to the increased contestation over European integration. *The European Elections of 2019 and beyond. European Union Politics* 23, 3–20. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165211036263>

- Vasilopoulou, S., Halikiopoulou, D., 2023. Democracy and discontent: institutional trust and evaluations of system performance among core and peripheral far right voters. *Journal of European Public Policy* 0, 1–25. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2023.2215816>
- Braun, D., Schäfer, C., 2022. Issues that mobilize Europe. The role of key policy issues for voter turnout in the 2019 European Parliament election. *European Union Politics* 23, 120–140. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165211040337>
- Baute, S., 2023. Mass Euroscepticism revisited: The role of distributive justice. *European Union Politics* 14651165231170788. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165231170789>
- Aichholzer, J., Kritzinger, S., Plescia, C., 2021. National identity profiles and support for the European Union. *European Union Politics* 22, 293–315. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520980068>
- Matthijs, M. and Merler, S., 2020. Mind the Gap: Southern Exit, Northern Voice and Changing Loyalties since the Euro Crisis. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 58(1), pp.96-115.
- Ford, R. and Jennings, W., 2020. The changing cleavage politics of Western Europe. *Annual Review of Political Science*, 23, pp.295-314.
- Schafheitle, S., Weibel, A., Meidert, N. and Leuffen, D., 2020. The Road to Trust. A Vignette Study on the Determinants of Citizens' Trust in the European Commission. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 58(2), pp.256-275.
- De Vries, C.E., 2018. Euroscepticism and the future of European integration. Oxford University Press.
- Schneider, C.J., 2018. The responsive union: National elections and European governance. Cambridge University Press.
- Aldrich, A. S. 2018. National Political Parties and Career Paths to the European Parliament. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56: pp.1283–1304.
- Hix, S. and Marsh, M., 2007. Punishment or Protest? Understanding European Parliament Elections. *Journal of Politics* 69(2), pp.495-510.
- Vasilopoulou, S. and Talving, L. 2018. Opportunity or threat? Public attitudes towards EU freedom of movement. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-19.
- Rooduijn, M., 2015. The rise of the populist radical right in Western Europe. *European View*, 14(1), pp.3-11.
- Jeannet, A.M., 2018. Internal migration and public opinion about the European Union: a time series cross-sectional study. *Socio-Economic Review*.
- Kostadinova, P. and Giurcanu, M. 2018. Capturing the legislative priorities of transnational Europarties and the European Commission: A pledge approach, *European Union Politics*, 19(2), pp.363–379.

- Senninger, R. and Bischof, D. 2018. Working in unison: Political parties and policy issue transfer in the multilevel space, *European Union Politics*, 19(1), pp.140–162.
- Sorace, M. 2018. Legislative Participation in the EU: An analysis of questions, speeches, motions and declarations in the 7th European Parliament. *European Union Politics*, 19(2), pp.299–320.
- Frid-Nielsen, S. S. 2018. Human rights or security? Positions on asylum in European Parliament speeches. *European Union Politics*, 19(2), pp.344–362.
- Cavallaro, M., Flacher, D., and Zanetti, M. A. 2018. Radical right parties and European economic integration: Evidence from the seventh European Parliament. *European Union Politics*, 19(2), pp.321–343.
- Tuttnauer, O., 2018. If you can beat them, confront them: Party-level analysis of opposition behavior in European national parliaments. *European Union Politics*, 19(2), pp.278–298.
- Hernández, E. 2018. Democratic discontent and support for mainstream and challenger parties: Democratic protest voting. *European Union Politics*, 19(3) pp.458–480
- Schulte-Cloos, J. 2018. Do European Parliament elections foster challenger parties' success on the national level?. *European Union Politics*, 19(3), pp.408–426.
- Franchino, F. and Segatti, P., 2019. Public opinion on the Eurozone fiscal union: evidence from survey experiments in Italy. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 26(1), pp.126–148.
- Kleider, H. and Stoeckel, F., 2019. The politics of international redistribution: Explaining public support for fiscal transfers in the EU. *European Journal of Political Research*, 58(1), pp.4–29.
- Anderson, C.J. and Hecht, J.D. 2018. The preference for Europe: Public opinion about European integration since 1952. *European Union Politics*, 19(4), pp.617–638.
- Beach, D., Hansen, K., and Larsen, M. 2018. How Campaigns Enhance European Issues Voting During European Parliament Elections. *Political Science Research and Methods*, 6(4), 791–808.
- Lefkofridi, Z. and Katsanidou, A. 2018. A Step Closer to a Transnational Party System? Competition and Coherence in the 2009 and 2014 European Parliament. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56: 1462–1482.
- Sorace, M. 2017. The European Union democratic deficit: Substantive representation in the European Parliament at the input stage. *European Union Politics*, p.1465116517741562.
- Nielsen, J.H. and Franklin, M.N. 2017. The 2014 European Parliament Elections: Still Second Order?. In *The Eurosceptic 2014 European Parliament Elections* (pp.1–16). Palgrave Macmillan UK.

- McEvoy, C. 2016. The Role of Political Efficacy on Public Opinion in the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 54(5), pp.1159-1174
- Hobolt, S.B. and de Vries, C.E. 2016. Public Support for European Integration. *Annual Review of Political Science*, 19, pp.413-432.
- Braun, D., Hutter, S. and Kersch, A. 2016. What type of Europe? The salience of polity and policy issues in European Parliament elections. *European Union Politics*, 17(4), pp.570-592.
- Baglioni, S. and Hurrelmann, A. 2016. The Eurozone crisis and citizen engagement in EU affairs. *West European Politics*, 39(1), pp.104-124.
- Oliver, T. 2016. European and international views of Brexit. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-8.
- Nielsen, J.H. 2016. Personality and Euroscepticism: The Impact of Personality on Attitudes Towards the EU. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*. 54(5), pp.1175–1198.
- Smith, K.E. 2016. Left out in the cold: Brexit, the EU and the perils of Trump's world. *LSE Brexit*. <http://eprints.lse.ac.uk/68777/>.
- Hix, S., Hagemann, S. and Frantescu, D. 2016. Would Brexit matter? The UK's voting record in the Council and the European Parliament. <http://eprints.lse.ac.uk/66261/>.
- Chopin, T. and Lequesne, C. 2016. Differentiation as a double-edged sword: member states' practices and Brexit. *International Affairs*, 92(3), pp.531-545.
- Dagnis Jensen, M. and Snaith, H. 2016. When politics prevails: the political economy of a Brexit. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-9.
- Hobolt, S.B. and de Vries, C.E. 2016. Public Support for European Integration. *Annual Review of Political Science*, 19, pp.413-432.
- Hobolt, S. and Spoon, J. 2012. Motivating the European voter: parties, issues and campaigns in European Parliament elections. *European Journal of Political Research* 51(6), pp.701-727.
- Hobolt, Sara B. 2012. Citizen Satisfaction with Democracy in the European Union*. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 50 (s1), pp.88–105.
- Armingeon, K, and B Ceka. 2014. The Loss of Trust in the European Union During the Great Recession Since 2007: the Role of Heuristics From the National Political System. *European Union Politics* 15 (1), pp.82–107.
- Ceka, B. 2013. The Perils of Political Competition: Explaining Participation and Trust in Political Parties in Eastern Europe. *Comparative Political Studies* 46 (12), pp.1610–35.
- Lefkofridi, Z. and Katsanidou, A. 2014. Multilevel representation in the European Parliament. *European Union Politics*, 15(1), pp.108-131.

- Kopecky, P. and Mudde, C. 2002. The Two Sides of Euroscepticism: Party Positions on European Integration in East Central Europe. *European Union Politics*, 3(3), pp.297–326.
- Franklin, M. and Hobolt, S.B. 2011. The Legacy of Lethargy: How Elections for the European Parliament Depress Turnout. *Electoral Studies* 30, pp.67-76.
- Gabel, M. 1998. Public Support for European Integration: An Empirical Test of Five Theories. *Journal of Politics* 60(3), pp.333–354.
- Garry, J. and Tilley, J. 2009. The Macroeconomic Factors Conditioning the Impact of Identity on Attitudes towards the EU. *European Union Politics* 10(3), pp.361–379.
- Hellström, J. 2008. Who Leads, Who Follows? Re-examining the Party-Electorate Linkages on European Integration. *Journal of European Public Policy* 15(8), pp.1127-44.
- Hix, S. and Marsh, M. 2011. Second-order effects plus pan-European political swings: An analysis of European Parliament elections across time. *Electoral Studies* 30, pp.4–15.
- Hobolt, S.B. 2009. *Europe in Question: Referendums on European Integration*. Oxford University Press.
- Hobolt, S.B., Spoon, J. and Tilley, J. 2009. A Vote Against Europe? Explaining Defection at the 1999 and 2004 European Parliament Elections. *British Journal of Political Science* 39(1), pp.93-115.
- Hobolt, S.B. and Wittrock, J. 2011. The second-order election model revisited: An experimental test of vote choices in European Parliament elections. *Electoral Studies* 30, pp.29–40.
- Hooghe, L. and Marks, G. 2006. Calculation, Community and Cues: Public Opinion on European Integration. *European Union Politics* 6(4), pp.419–43.
- Steenbergen, M.R., Edwards, E.E. and de Vries, C.E. 2007. Who's Cueing Whom? Mass- Elite Linkages and the Future of European Integration. *European Union Politics* 8(1), pp.39-49.

Week 8

Reading week - no lectures

Week 9

Interest representation

Study questions

- What are interest groups and why do we study them in the EU context?

- Describe the different access point through which lobbyists attempt to influence EU policy making. Do the institutional structures of the Commission, EP, and Council aid or hinder lobbyists in their lobbying attempts?
- What different types of factors have been identified as influencing lobbying success in the EU?
- What attempts have been made to regulate EU lobbying? Have these attempts been successful?
- How do interest groups and lobbyists contribute to or challenge the democratic legitimacy of the EU?
- Can you identify any landmark lobbying campaigns that have significantly impacted EU policy?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. *European Union Politics*. Oxford University Press. Chapter 13.
- Hix, S. and Høyland, B. 2022. *The political system of the European Union*. Palgrave Macmillan. Chapter 7.
- Bouwen, P. 2004. Exchanging access goods for access: A comparative study of business lobbying in the European Union Institutions. *European Journal of Political Research*, 43: 337–369
- Dür, A., Bernhagen, P., and Marshall, D. 2015. Interest Group Success in the European Union When (and Why) Does Business Lose?. *Comparative Political Studies*, 48(8), pp.951-983.

Further reading

- Binderkrantz, A.S., Blom-Hansen, J., Senninger, R., 2020. Countering bias? The EU Commission's consultation with interest groups. *Journal of European Public Policy*.
- Stevens, F., De Bruycker, I., 2020. Influence, affluence and media salience: Economic resources and lobbying influence in the European Union. *European Union Politics* 21, 728–750. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520944572>
- van der Pas, K., n.d. All That Glitters Is Not Gold? Civil Society Organisations and the (non-)Mobilisation of European Union Law. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* n/a. <https://doi.org/10.1111/jcms.13515>
- Wonka, A., 2022. Policy and constituency frames in the advocacy of political parties and interest groups in policy-making. *Journal of European Public Policy* 0, 1–22. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2022.2138952>
- Binderkrantz, A.S., Blom-Hansen, J., Senninger, R., 2020. Countering bias? The EU Commission's consultation with interest groups. *Journal of European Public Policy*.

- European Commission for Democracy Through Law (Venice Commission). 2013. Report on the Role of Extra-Institutional Actors in the Democratic System.
- Coen, D. 2007. Empirical and theoretical studies in EU lobbying. *Journal of European Public Policy* 14(3), pp.333-345.
- Marshall, D. 2010. Who to lobby and when: Institutional determinants of interest group strategies in European Parliament committees. *European Union Politics*, 11(4), pp.553-575.
- Bunea, A. 2018. Regulating European Union lobbying: in whose interest?. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-21.
- Flöthe, L. and Rasmussen, A., 2018. Public voices in the heavenly chorus? Group type bias and opinion representation. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-19.
- Judge, A. and Thomson, R., 2018. The responsiveness of legislative actors to stakeholders' demands in the European Union. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-20.
- Wonka, A., De Bruycker, I., De Bièvre, D., Braun, C., and Beyers, J. 2018. Patterns of Conflict and Mobilization: Mapping Interest Group Activity in EU Legislative Policymaking. *Politics and Governance*, 6(3), 136-146.
- Hollman, M. and Murdoch, Z. 2018. Lobbying cycles in Brussels: Evidence from the rotating presidency of the Council of the European Union. *European Union Politics*, 19(4), pp.597-616.
- Røed, M., and Wøien Hansen, V. (2018) Explaining Participation Bias in the European Commission's Online Consultations: The Struggle for Policy Gain without too Much Pain. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56: 1446–1461.
- De Bruycker, I. 2016. Power and position: Which EU party groups do lobbyists prioritize and why? *Party Politics* 22(4), pp.552-562.
- van der Graaf, A., Otjes, S. and Rasmussen, A. 2016. Weapon of the weak? The social media landscape of interest groups. *European Journal of Communication*, 31(2), pp.120-135.
- De Bruycker, I. 2016. Pressure and Expertise: Explaining the Information Supply of Interest Groups in EU Legislative Lobbying. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies* 54(3), pp.599-616.
- Beyers, J., De Bruycker, I. and Baller, I. 2015. The alignment of parties and interest groups in EU legislative politics. A tale of two different worlds?. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(4), pp.534-551.
- Klüver, H., Mahoney, C. and Opper, M. 2015. Framing in context: how interest groups employ framing to lobby the European Commission. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(4), pp.481-498.
- Klüver, H. and Mahoney, C. 2015. Measuring interest group framing strategies in public policy debates. *Journal of Public Policy*, 35(02), pp.223-244.

- Eising, R., Rasch, D. and Rozbicka, P. 2015. Institutions, policies, and arguments: context and strategy in EU policy framing. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 22(4), pp.516-533.
- Boräng, F. and Naurin, D. 2015. ‘Try to see it my way!’ Frame congruence between lobbyists and European Commission officials. *Journal of European Public Policy* 22(4), pp.499-515.
- Beyers, J., Bonafont, L. C., Dür, A., Eising, R., Fink-Hafner, D., Lowery, D., ... and Naurin, D. 2014. The INTEREURO project: Logic and structure. *Interest Groups & Advocacy*, 3(2), 126-140.
- Chari, R. Murphy, G. and Hogan, J. 2007. Regulating Lobbyists: A Comparative Analysis of the USA, Canada, Germany and the European Union, *The Political Quarterly*, 78(3), pp.422-438.
- Coen, D. 1998. The European business interest and the nation state: large-firm lobbying in the European Union and member states. *Journal of Public Policy*, 18(01), pp.75-100.
- Mahoney, C. and Baumgartner, F. 2008. Converging perspectives on interest group research in Europe and America. *West European Politics*, 31(6), pp.1253–1273.
- Beyers, J. 2008. Policy Issues, Organizational Format and the Political Strategies of Interest Organizations. *West European Politics* 31(6), pp.1188-1211.
- Beyers, J. and Kerremans, B. 2004. Bureaucrats, Politicians, and Societal Interests: How Is European Policy Making Politicized?” *Comparative Political Studies* 37(10), pp.1119-1150.
- Börzel, T. and Heard-Lauréote, K. 2009. Networks in EU Multi-level governance: Concepts and Contributions. *Journal of Public Policy* 29(2), pp.135-152.
- Coen, D and Richardson, J (eds) (2009) *Lobbying the European Union*, Oxford: Oxford University Press.
- Dür, A. 2008. Interest groups in the European Union: How Powerful are They?” *West European Politics* 31(6), pp.1212-1230.
- Eising, R. 2007. The access of business interests to EU institutions: towards elite pluralism? *Journal of European Public Policy* 14(3), pp.384-403.
- Eising, R. 2008. Interest Group in EU policymaking. *Living Reviews in European Governance* Vol. 3 (<http://europeangovernance.livingreviews.org/Articles/lreg-2008-4/>).
- Greenwood, J. 2007a. *Interest Representation in the European Union*, Hampshire: Palgrave Macmillan.
- Greenwood, J. 2007b. Review Article: Organized Civil Society and Democratic Legitimacy in the EU. *British Journal of Political Science* 37: 333-35.

- Klüver, H. 2010. Measuring Interest Group Influence using Quantitative Text Analysis. *European Union Politics* 10(4), pp.535- 549.
- Mahoney, C. 2008. *Brussels versus the Beltway. Advocacy in the United States and the European Union.* Washington DC: Georgetown University Press.
- Mahoney, C. 2007. Lobbying Success in the United State and the European Union. *Journal of Public Policy* 27(2), pp.35-56.
- Quittkat, C. 2011. The European Commission's Online Consultations: a Success Story? *Journal of Common Market Studies* 49(3), pp.653-674.
- Skodvin, T., Gullberg, A.T., and Aakre, S. 2010. Target-group influence and political feasibility: the case of climate policy design in Europe. *Journal of European Public Policy* 17(6), pp.854- 873.

Week 10

Brexit

Study questions

- What factors explain the outcome of the Brexit referendum vote?
- What factors explain the outcome of the Brexit negotiations between the UK and the EU?
- How has Ireland, a much small country than the UK, managed to have its views enshrined in the withdrawal agreement?
- How is Brexit (if it goes ahead) likely to affect EU decision-making?
- How have the Brexit negotiations impacted the relationships between EU member states?
- What are the long-term implications of Brexit for the EU's policy agenda?
- How has Brexit influenced public opinion about the EU in both the UK and the remaining member states?

Required Readings

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. *European Union Politics.* Oxford University Press. Chapter 26.
- Hobolt, S. B. 2016. The Brexit vote: a divided nation, a divided continent. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 23(9), pp.1259-1277.
- Huhe, N., Naurin, D. and Thomson, R., 2020. Don't cry for me Britannia: The resilience of the European Union to Brexit. *European Union Politics*, 21(1), pp.152-172.
- Jones, E. 2018. Four Things We Should Learn from Brexit, *Survival*, 60:6, pp.35-44.

Further reading

- Fetzer, T., 2019. Austerity caused Brexit [WWW Document]. CEPR. URL <https://cepr.org/voxeu/caused-brexit> (accessed 9.4.23).
- Carl, N., Dennison, J., Evans, G., 2019. European but not European enough: An explanation for Brexit. *European Union Politics* 20, 282–304. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116518802361>
- Bulmer, S., Quaglia, L., 2018. The politics and economics of Brexit. *Journal of European Public Policy* 25, 1089–1098. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2018.1467957>
- Davies, W., 2019. Leave, and Leave Again. *London Review of Books* 41.
- Fetzer, T., 2019. Austerity caused Brexit [WWW Document]. CEPR. URL <https://cepr.org/voxeu/caused-brexit> (accessed 9.4.23).
- Gastinger, M., 2021. Introducing the EU exit index measuring each member state’s propensity to leave the European Union. *European Union Politics* 22, 566–585. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165211000138>
- Hobolt, S.B., Popa, S.A., Van der Brug, W., Schmitt, H., 2022. The Brexit deterrent? How member state exit shapes public support for the European Union. *European Union Politics* 23, 100–119. <https://doi.org/10.1177/14651165211032766>
- Huhe, N., Naurin, D., Thomson, R., 2020. Don’t cry for me Britannia: The resilience of the European Union to Brexit. *European Union Politics* 21, 152–172. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116519882096>
- Jones, E., 2018. Four Things We Should Learn from Brexit. *Survival* 60, 35–44. <https://doi.org/10.1080/00396338.2018.1542799>
- Carl, N., Dennison, J., Evans, G., 2019. European but not European enough: An explanation for Brexit. *European Union Politics* 20, 282–304. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116518802361>
- Bulmer, S., Quaglia, L., 2018. The politics and economics of Brexit. *Journal of European Public Policy* 25, 1089–1098. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2018.1467957>
- Hobolt, S., Adrian Popa, S., van der Brug, W. and Schmitt, H., 2021. The Brexit deterrent? How member state exit shapes public support for the European Union. *European Union Politics*.
- Yordanova, N., Angelova, M., Lehrer, R., Osnabrügge, M. and Renes, S., 2020. Swaying citizen support for EU membership: Evidence from a survey experiment of German voters. *European Union Politics*, 21(3), pp.429–450.
- Kirsch, W. 2016. Brexit and the Distribution of Power in the Council of the EU, CEPS Commentaries, pp.1-4.

- Springford, J. 2018. Theresa May's Irish trilemma. <https://www.cer.eu/insights/theresa-mays-irish-trilemma>.
- Patel, O. & Reh, C. 2016. Brexit: The Consequences for the EU Political System, UCL Constitution Unit Briefing Paper, pp.1-5.
- Staal, K. 2016. Brexit Implications for Influence on EU Decision Making, The Stability of Regions, Culture, and Institutions VIVES Workshop, University of Leuven, Belgium, pp.1-6.
- Inglehart, R., & Norris, P. 2016. Trump, Brexit, and the rise of populism: Economic have-nots and cultural backlash. HKS Working Paper No. RWP16-026. Available at SSRN: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=2818659>.
- European Commission. 2019. Withdrawal of the United Kingdom from the EU. Available here: https://ec.europa.eu/taxation_customs/uk_withdrawal_en
- Lavery, S., McDaniel, S. and Schmid, D., 2018. Finance fragmented? Frankfurt and Paris as European financial centres after Brexit. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-19.
- Jennings, W. and Lodge, M. 2018. Brexit, the tides and Canute: the fracturing politics of the British state, *Journal of European Public Policy*
- Qvortrup, M. 2016. Referendums on Membership and European Integration 1972–2015. *The Political Quarterly*, 87, pp.61-68.
- Henderson, A. , Jeffery, C. , Liñeira, R. , Scully, R. , Wincott, D. and Wyn Jones, R. 2016. England, Englishness and Brexit. *The Political Quarterly*, 87, pp.187-199.
- James, S. and Quaglia, L. 2018. The Brexit Negotiations and Financial Services: A Two-Level Game Analysis. *The Political Quarterly*, 89, pp.560-567.
- Renwick, A. , Allan, S. , Jennings, W. , McKee, R. , Russell, M. and Smith, G. 2018. What Kind of Brexit do Voters want? Lessons from the Citizens' Assembly on Brexit. *The Political Quarterly*, 89, pp.649-658.
- Laffan, B. 2018. Brexit: Re-opening Ireland's English Question. *The Political Quarterly*, 89, pp.568-575.
- Chen W, Los B, McCann P, Ortega-Argilés R, Thissen M, van Oort F. 2018. The continental divide? Economic exposure to Brexit in regions and countries on both sides of The Channel. *Papers in Regional Science*. 97, pp.25–54.
- Richardson, J. 2018. Brexit: The EU Policy-Making State Hits the Populist Buffers. *The Political Quarterly*, 89, pp.118-126.
- Richards, L. , Heath, A. and Carl, N. 2018. Red Lines and Compromises: Mapping Underlying Complexities of Brexit Preferences. *The Political Quarterly*, 89, pp.280-290.
- Hantzsche, A. , Kara, A. and Young, G. 2018. The Economic Effects of the UK Government's Proposed Brexit Deal. *The World Economy*, Accepted Author Manuscript.

- Gasiorrek, M. , Serwicka, I. and Smith, A. 2019. Which Manufacturing Industries and Sectors Are Most Vulnerable to Brexit?. *The World Economy*, Accepted Author Manuscript.
- Manners, I. 2018. Political Psychology of European Integration: The (Re)production of Identity and Difference in the Brexit Debate. *Political Psychology*, 39, pp.1213-1232.
- Warlouzet, L. 2018. Britain at the Centre of European Co-operation (1948–2016). *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56, pp.955–970.
- Dhingra, S., & Sampson, T. 2016. Life after BREXIT: What are the UK's options outside the European Union?. CEPBREXIT01. London School of Economics and Political Science, CEP, London, UK.
- Goodwin, M. J., & Heath, O. 2016. The 2016 Referendum, Brexit and the Left Behind: An Aggregate-level Analysis of the Result. *The Political Quarterly*, 87(3), pp.323-332.
- Grant, C. 2016. The Impact of Brexit on the EU, Centre for European Reform, blog post, 24 June 2016.
- Kierzenkowski, R., et al. 2016. The Economic Consequences of Brexit: A Taxing Decision, OECD Economic Policy Papers, No. 16, OECD Publishing, Paris. <http://dx.doi.org/10.1787/5jm01svdkf6k-en>.
- Kaufmann, E. 2016. It's NOT the economy, stupid: Brexit as a story of personal values. *British Politics and Policy at LSE*.
- Whitman, R. G. 2016. Brexit or Bremain: what future for the UK's European diplomatic strategy?. *International Affairs*, 92(3), pp.509-529.
- Ottaviano, G. I. P., Pessoa, J. P., Sampson, T., & Van Reenen, J. 2014. Brexit or Fixit? The trade and welfare effects of leaving the European Union.
- Oliver, T. 2016. European and international views of Brexit. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 23(9), pp.1321-1328.
- Menon, A., & Salter, J. P. 2016. Brexit: initial reflections. *International Affairs*, 92(6), pp.1297-1318.
- Jensen, M. D., & Snaith, H. 2016. When politics prevails: the political economy of a Brexit. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 23(9), pp.1302-1310.
- Oliver, T., & Williams, M. J. 2016. Special relationships in flux: Brexit and the future of the US—EU and US—UK relationships. *International Affairs*, 92(3), pp.547-567.

Week 11

The EU's democratic deficit and EU transparency

Study questions

- What is a democratic deficit? Does the EU suffer from a lack of democratic legitimacy? Should we hold the EU to the same ideals of democratic legitimacy as we do nation states?
- How transparent is the EU? How has this changed over time? Is increasing transparency a potential way in which to make the EU more democratic and legitimate?
- How do the principles and practices of subsidiarity and proportionality relate to the democratic legitimacy of the EU?
- What role do the media and public opinion play in enhancing or undermining the EU's democratic legitimacy?
- Has the EU made significant strides in improving its transparency, and what challenges remain?

Key reading

- Cini, M. and Borragán, N.P.S. 2025. European Union Politics. Oxford University Press. Chapter 27.
- Follesdal, A. and Hix, S. 2006. Why There is a Democratic Deficit in the EU: A Response to Majone and Moravcsik. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 44(3), pp.533-62.
- Moravcsik, A. 2008. The Myth of Europe's "Democratic Deficit". *Intereconomics: Journal of European Economic Policy* 43(6), pp.331-40.
- European Commission. 2019. A-Z Index of Euromyths 1992 to 2017. Read 2-3 examples from here: <https://blogs.ec.europa.eu/ECintheUK/euromyths-a-z-index/>
- Presidency of the Council of the European Union, 2001. Presidency Conclusions, European Council Meeting in Laeken (The Laeken Declaration). https://www.consilium.europa.eu/uedocs/cms_data/docs/pressdata/en/ec/68827.pdf
- Naurin, D. 2007. *Deliberation Behind Closed Doors. Transparency and Lobbying in the European Union*. Colchester: ECPR Press. Ch1-2.

Further reading

- Hobolt, S.B., Wratil, C., 2020. Contestation and responsiveness in EU Council deliberations. *Journal of European Public Policy* 27, 362–381. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2020.1712454>
- Jackson, D., Jolly, S., 2021. A new divide? Assessing the transnational-nationalist dimension among political parties and the public across the EU. *European Union Politics* 22, 316–339. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1465116520988915>

- Kelemen, R.D., 2020a. The European Union's authoritarian equilibrium. *Journal of European Public Policy* 27, 481–499. <https://doi.org/10.1080/13501763.2020.1712455>
- Wratil, C., 2019. Territorial Representation and the Opinion–Policy Linkage: Evidence from the European Union. *American Journal of Political Science* 63, 197–211. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ajps.12403>
- Brandsma, G.J. 2018. Transparency of EU informal trilogues through public feedback in the European Parliament: promise unfulfilled. *Journal of European Public Policy*, pp.1-20.
- Kreuder-Sonnen, C. 2018. Political secrecy in Europe: crisis management and crisis exploitation. *West European Politics*, 41(4), pp.958-980.
- Blatter, J., Schmid, S. D., and Blättler, A. C. (2017) Democratic Deficits in Europe: The Overlooked Exclusiveness of Nation-States and the Positive Role of the European Union. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 55: 449–467.
- Karlsson, C., and Persson, T. 2018. The Alleged Opposition Deficit in European Union Politics: Myth or Reality?. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 56: 888–905.
- Bølstad, J. 2015. Dynamics of European integration: Public opinion in the core and periphery. *European Union Politics*, 16(1), pp.23-44.
- Crombez, C. 2003. The Democratic Deficit in the European Union: Much Ado about Nothing? *European Union Politics* 4, pp.101-20.
- Habermas, J. 2008. *Europe: The Faltering Project*. Cambridge: Polity Press.
- Hix, S. 2013. *What's Wrong with the Europe Union and How to Fix it*. John Wiley & Sons.
- Majone, G. 2000. The Credibility Crisis of Community Regulation. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 38(2), pp.273–302.
- Moravcsik, A. 2002. In Defence of the Democratic Deficit: Reassessing Legitimacy in the European Union. *Journal of Common Market Studies* 40(4), pp.603-24.
- Kohler-Koch, B. and Rittberger, B. 2007. *Debating the Democratic Legitimacy of the European Union*. Lanham, MD: Rowman and Littlefield.
- Thomson, R. 2011. *Resolving Controversy in the EU*. Cambridge University Press. Chapter 12.
- Zweifel, T. D. 2002. Who is without sin cast the first stone: the EU's democratic deficit in comparison. *Journal of European Public Policy* 9(5), pp.812-840.
- Cross, J.P. 2013a. Striking a pose: transparency and position taking in the Council of the European Union. *European Journal of Political Research*, 52(3), pp.291–315.

- Cross, J.P. 2014. The seen and the unseen in legislative politics: Explaining censorship in the Council of Ministers of the European Union. *Journal of European Public Policy*, 21(2), pp.268-285.
- de Fine Licht, J., Naurin, D., Esaiasson, P. and Gilljam, M. 2011. Does transparency generate legitimacy? An experimental study of procedure acceptance of open-and closed-door decision-making. *QoG Working Paper Series*, 2011(8), p.8.
- Levy, G. 2007. Decision making in committees: Transparency, reputation, and voting rules. *American Economic Review*, 97(1), pp.150–168.
- Lodge, J. 1994. Transparency and democratic legitimacy. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 32(3), pp.343–368.
- Settembri, P. 2005. Transparency and the EU Legislator: “Let He Who is Without Sin Cast the First Stone”. *JCMS: Journal of Common Market Studies*, 43(3), pp.637–654.
- Stasavage, D. 2006. Does transparency make a difference? The example of the European Council of Ministers. In *Proceedings-British Academy* 135, p.165. Oxford University Press Inc..
- Stasavage, D. 2004. Open-door or closed-door? Transparency in domestic and international bargaining. *International Organization*, 58(04), pp.667–703.

Week 12

Revision and exam preparation

AI as a Learning Partner: Enhanced Guidelines

Philosophy: AI for Deep Learning, Not Quick Answers

Generative AI tools should enhance your critical thinking and understanding of EU politics, not replace it. This section provides a framework for using AI as an intellectual partner that deepens your engagement with course material while maintaining the highest academic standards.

Core Principle: Use AI to ask better questions, explore complex ideas, and develop stronger arguments—not to generate ready-made answers.

Learning-Centred AI - A 3-stage process for using AI to support learning

Stage 1: Exploration & Discovery

- **Purpose:** Use AI to explore topics, identify knowledge gaps, and generate research directions
- **Learning Objective:** Develop curiosity and identify areas for deeper investigation
- **Example Prompts:**
 - “What are the most contested aspects of EU democratic legitimacy, and why do scholars disagree?”
 - “Help me understand the different perspectives on Brexit’s impact on EU integration theory”
 - “What questions should I be asking about the EU’s response to migration?”
- **Critical Task:** Always ask yourself: “What don’t I understand yet? What assumptions am I making?”

Stage 2: Analysis & Argument Development

- **Purpose:** Use AI to test arguments, explore counterarguments, and refine analytical thinking
- **Learning Objective:** Strengthen argumentation skills and consider multiple perspectives
- **Example Prompts:**
 - “I argue that [your position]. What are the strongest counterarguments to this view?”
 - “Help me identify weaknesses in this policy recommendation: [your idea]”
 - “What evidence would I need to support the claim that [specific EU policy] has been effective?”
- **Critical Task:** Engage with AI responses critically—don’t accept them at face value

Stage 3: Refinement & Quality Control

- **Purpose:** Use AI to improve clarity, identify gaps, and enhance presentation
- **Learning Objective:** Develop self-editing skills and professional writing standards
- **Example Prompts:**
 - “Is my argument clear and logically structured? Where could it be strengthened?”
 - “What important perspectives or evidence am I missing from this analysis?”
 - “How can I make this policy recommendation more actionable and specific?”
- **Critical Task:** Maintain your voice and perspective—AI should enhance, not replace your ideas

Quality Assurance: Evaluating AI Output

Before incorporating any AI-generated content or insights, you should consider applying the following evaluation framework to assess the quality and usefulness of the outputs generated:

Reliability Check:

1. **Source Verification:** Can you find independent sources that support these claims?
2. **Logical Consistency:** Do the arguments make sense within the context of the course content and broader research on EU politics?
3. **Currency Check:** Is this information up-to-date and relevant to current EU developments?
4. **Perspective Balance:** Does the response represent multiple viewpoints or just one angle?

Red Flags - When AI Output May Be Unreliable:

- Specific statistics without clear sources
- Claims about recent events without verification
- Oversimplified explanations of complex EU processes
- Definitive statements about contentious political issues
- Citations that you cannot independently verify

EU Politics-Specific AI Strategies

For Policy Analysis:

- Use AI to explore policy trade-offs: “What are the unintended consequences of [EU policy]?”
- Test institutional analysis: “How might different EU institutions view this issue differently?”
- Examine how a policy might be affected by multi-level governance considerations: “How does this policy affect national, EU, and subnational levels?”

For Theory Application:

- Test theoretical frameworks: “How would neofunctionalist theory explain [current EU development]?”
- Compare theoretical predictions: “Where do liberal intergovernmentalism and neofunctionalism disagree on this issue?”
- Explore theoretical evolution: “How have theories of European integration adapted to recent crises?”

Recommended AI Tools by Learning Function

Deep Learning & Analysis:

- ChatGPT: <https://chat.openai.com> - Complex reasoning and argument development
- Claude: <https://claude.ai/chat> - Critical analysis and counterargument generation
- Perplexity: <https://www.perplexity.ai> - Research synthesis with source verification

Academic Research:

- Elicit: <https://elicit.org> - Literature discovery and research question formulation
- Semantic Scholar: <https://www.semanticscholar.org> - Academic source identification
- SciSpace: <https://typeset.io> - Paper analysis and concept explanation

Writing & Communication:

- Grammarly: <https://www.grammarly.com> - Language clarity and professional tone
- Quillbot: <https://quillbot.com/> - Paraphrasing and style improvement
- Jenni: <https://jenni.ai> - Academic writing structure and flow

Academic Integrity & AI

All AI use must comply with UCD's academic integrity policies: <https://libguides.ucd.ie/academicintegrity>

Acceptable AI Use:

- Brainstorming and idea exploration
- Argument testing and refinement
- Language improvement and clarity enhancement
- Research direction identification
- Critical analysis development

Unacceptable AI Use:

- Direct copy-paste of AI-generated text without attribution
- Using AI to write complete sections without intellectual engagement
- Relying on AI for factual claims without independent verification
- Using AI to avoid engaging with course readings and materials

Remember:

The goal is to become a more sophisticated thinker about EU politics, not just to complete assignments efficiently. AI should challenge your thinking, not replace it.